



Ms. Right

Dating apps and their relationship

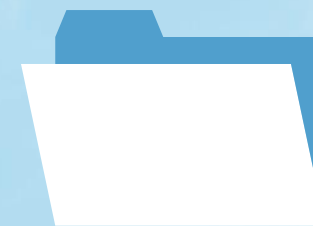


Presented by Group 3:
DING CHUAN
Other Group Members

with body image, mental health and
wellbeing: A systematic review



some lessons



some mistakes



Mr. Right

Background, Context & Main Argument



Section 1



Me.jpg



Alex.jpg



What the ad is about



01 It is about empowerment

03 Women decide whether to
make the first move

02 The ball is in her court

04 BFF mode (friendships)

05 Bizz mode (professional networking)

06 Dating apps are mainstream





Mayor.jpg



Modern Love.jpg

Dating apps

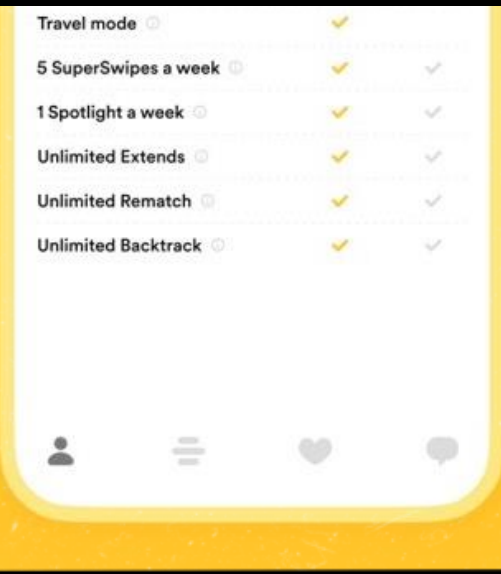
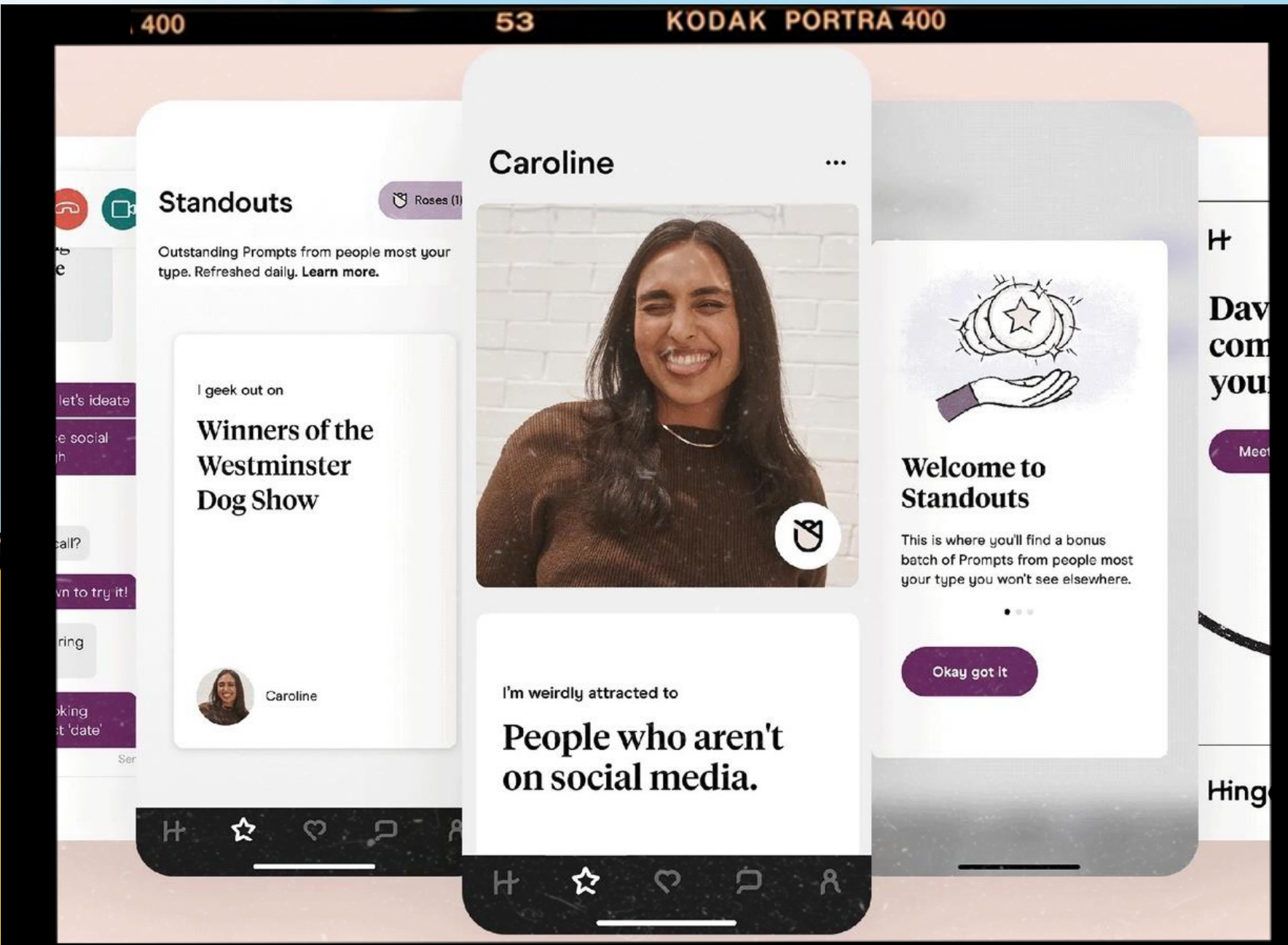
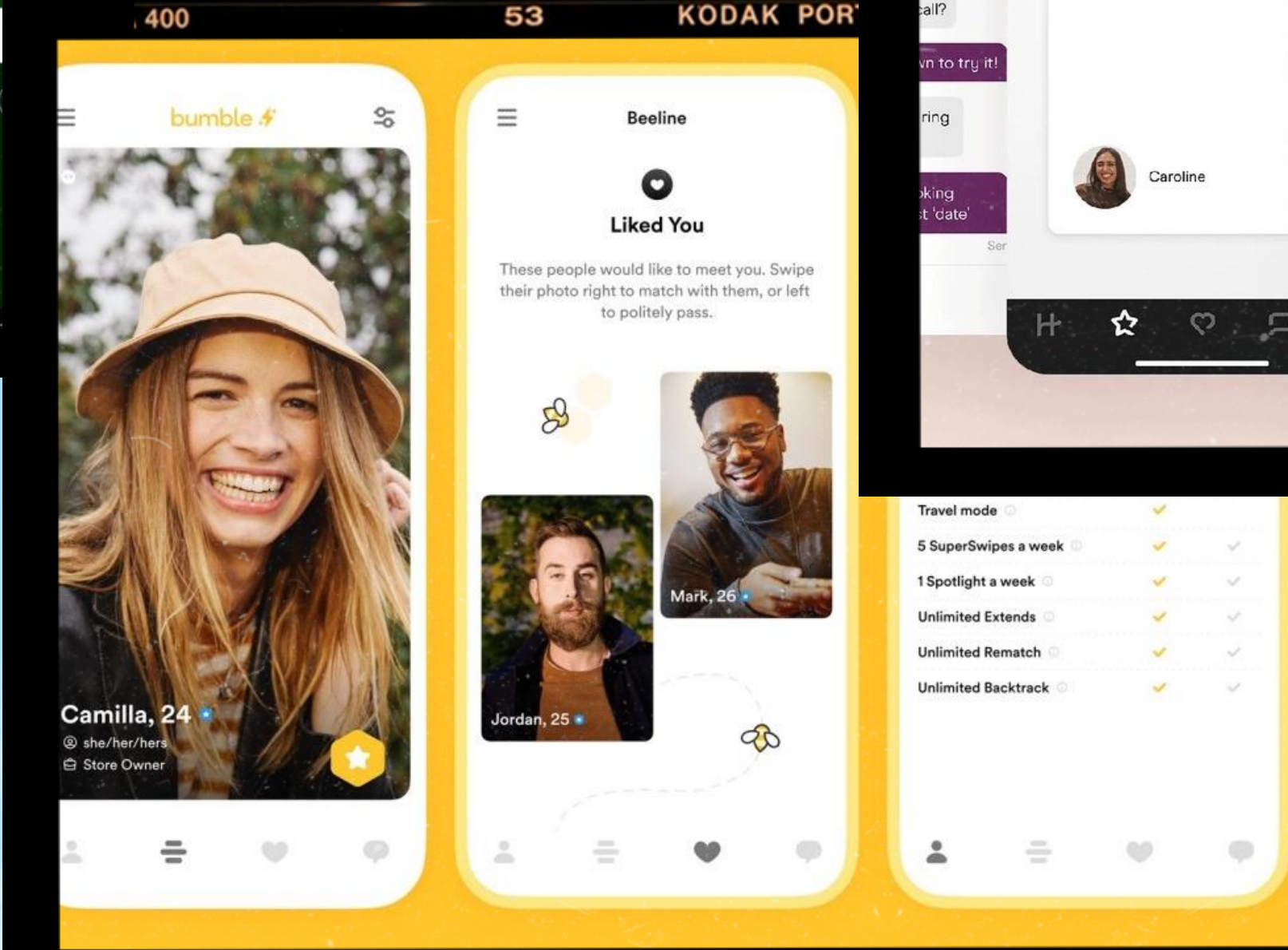
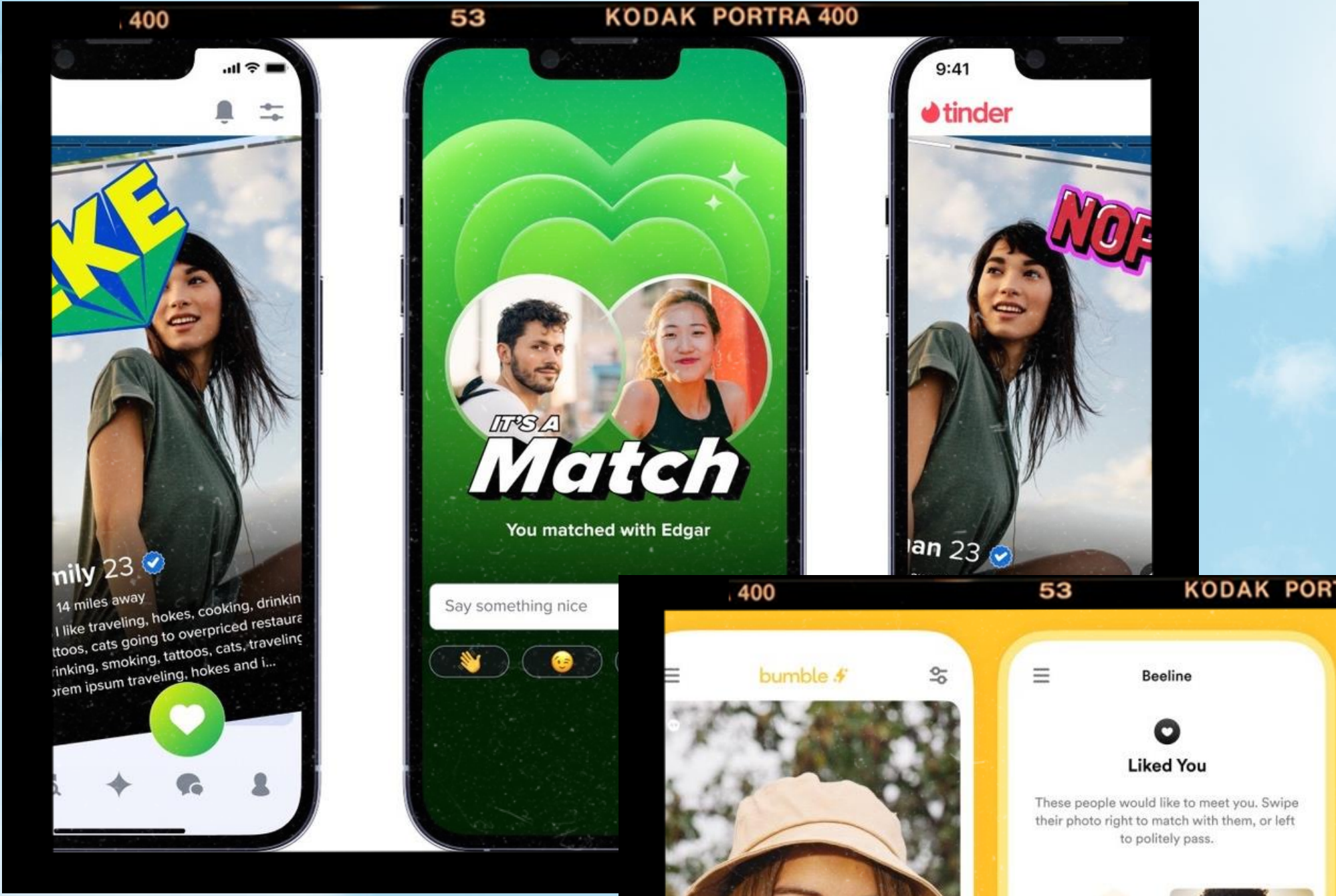
in 2026



Deep in everyday culture

380 million	60 million	Pop culture moment	Celebrity who use dating app
Monthly active user	Tinder	TV Show Modern Love	Zohran Mamdani

The question this raises: what is that experience actually doing to people?



Three concepts to keep in *mind*



01

Body Image

Perceptions and feelings about one's own appearance — body size, shape, attractiveness. Spans a spectrum from positive to negative. Shaped by social comparisons, social media, and — as this paper argues — dating apps.

02

Active vs Passive Use

Active use = messaging, connecting, engaging. Passive use = swiping and scrolling without reaching out. Passive use is the dominant behaviour on dating apps. It is also, as we will see, the most psychologically costly.

03

Mental Health vs Wellbeing

Mental health = longer-term functioning: depression, anxiety, psychological distress. Wellbeing = immediate state: mood, self-esteem, life satisfaction. The paper looks at both, and they are distinct but related.

Central Argument



what it is and what it argues

Dating apps are associated with potentially harmful effects on users' body image, mental health, and wellbeing.

Not in every study, not for every person — but consistently enough that the authors treat it as a genuine public health concern.

We are in 2026. These apps have been growing for over a decade. The research has been accumulating. This review takes that evidence seriously.

Methodology & Key Findings



Section 2



Judy.jpg



Mike.jpg

How the review was conducted



PRISMA Framework

Followed the gold standard for systematic reviews.



Pre-registered on OSF

Methodology locked in advance to avoid cherry-picking.



6 Academic Databases

Searched PsycINFO, MEDLINE, Scopus, Web of Science & more.



Studies since 2007

Focused on the era when geolocational mobile dating apps first appeared.



Quality Assessed via MMAT

Evaluated studies using the Mixed Methods Appraisal Tool.



Excellent Inter-rater Reliability

Cohen's Kappa values of 0.83 (abstract) and 0.92 (full-text).

From 1,362 Studies to 45: A Systematic Review Process

1,362 Retrieved from databases

1,235 After removing 127 duplicates

99 After title and abstract screening

45 Final included studies
Selected for qualitative analysis



Overall Quality Score

85.8

Excellent overall quality level



High-Scoring ($\geq 80\%$)

75.6%

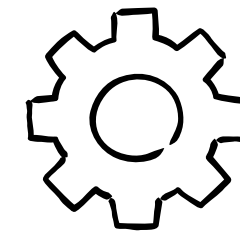
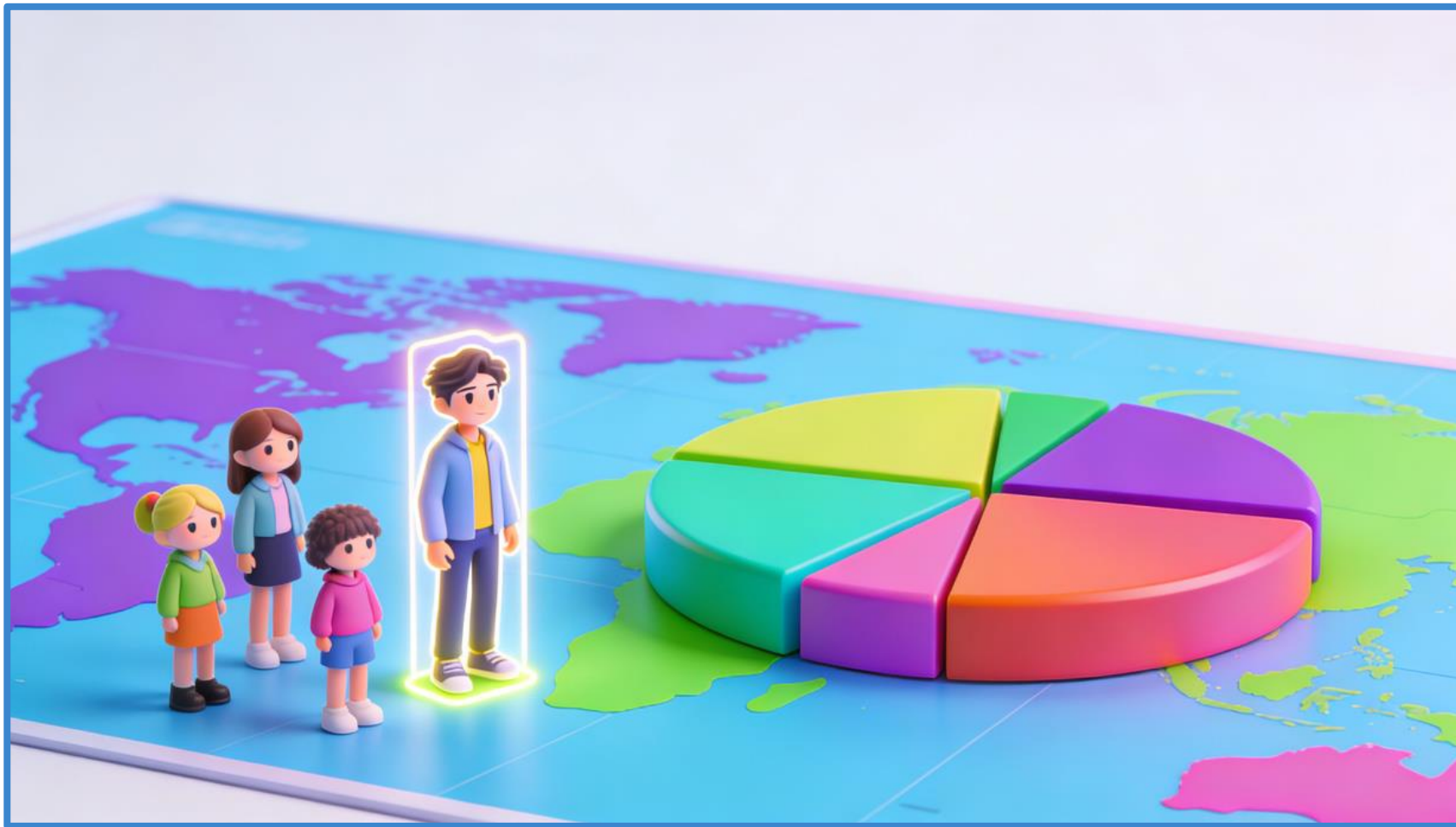
Core of our evidence base



Low Quality Note

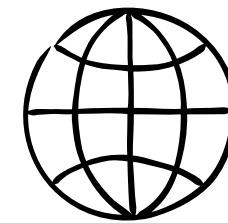
Only 1 study scored low (40%), excluded from primary analysis to ensure robustness.

Who Are Our 'Digital Daters' in the Sample?



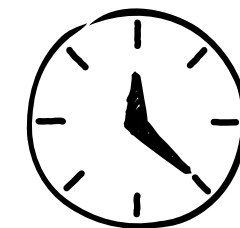
Study design

88.9% cross-sectional, 4 longitudinal
1 experimental.



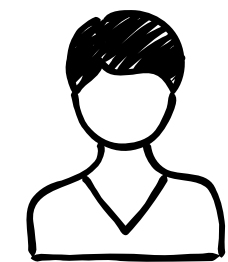
Geography

42.2% North America, 28.9% Europe, 13.3% Oceania, 4.4% Asia only.



Age

18–72, mean 26.7 years — firmly within the
core dating app demographic.

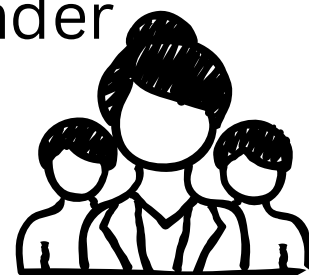


Gender

44.4% men exclusively, 35.6% sexual minority
men specifically, only 6.7% women exclusively.

Apps

62% measured 'dating app use' broadly; Tinder
(18%), Grindr (7%), gay apps (11%).



Finding 1: Negative impact on body image

86.4% of body image studies (n=22) reported significant adverse associations with dating app use

Positive associations

body dissatisfaction (8 studies), disordered eating (6), body surveillance (4), unhealthy weight control behaviours (4).

Unhealthy behaviours included

induced vomiting, laxative use, diet pill use, anabolic steroid use.

Qualitative evidence

Waling et al. found heterosexual men experienced discomfort when failing to meet app body ideals.

Filice et al. noted a culture of social comparison and self-objectification on Grindr.

Tran et al. reported most participants used weight control to conform to body ideals.



2 longitudinal studies: dating app use significantly predicted increased disordered eating over 7- and 14-day periods.

Finding 2: Negative impact on mental health & wellbeing damage

48.3% of mental health/wellbeing studies (n=29) found significant harmful associations.



depression (4)



anxiety (3)



Lowered
Self-esteem (4)



Increased
Stress(4)

 The Paradox of Choice: Partner
Overload

Thomas et al. (2022):The ONLY experimental study on app choice overload.

Finding:More available partners =worse feelings& lower self-esteem.

Insight:Decision fatigue and decreased satisfaction are real side effects of "too much choice".



The Paradox of Choice: Partner
Overload

Ghosting:Linked to severe negative mood shifts and self-esteem dips. It's a digital slap.

Early Starters:Women using appsbefore 18shows significantly higher anxiety.

Impact:Digital rejection leaves lasting emotional scars.

Strengths of the paper



Section 3



Strength 1

Rigorous, pre-registered methodology



- Pre-registration (OSF)
- Locked in research design before data collection
- Prevents bias and post-hoc outcome selection
- Ensures conclusions are independent of results



- Inter-rater reliability (Cohen's Kappa)
- Abstract screening: 0.83 (substantial agreement)
- Full-text screening: 0.92 (near-perfect agreement)
- Consistent, objective inclusion process



- PRISMA compliance
- Full reproducibility and transparency
- All decisions documented & auditable
- No "black box" methodology



Strength 2

Breadth and recency of evidence



45 studies spanning 2016–2023, covering a wide range of dating apps, countries, populations, and outcome measures. This is a comprehensive synthesis, not a narrow sample.



86.7% of included studies were published from 2020 onwards — this review is capturing a rapidly expanding literature at a significant moment in its development.



Crucially, both quantitative and qualitative research were included. Quantitative data gives us statistical associations and prevalence. Qualitative interviews — particularly Filice et al. with gay men on Grindr, and Tran et al. with young gay and bisexual men — give us the lived human experience behind those numbers.



That combination is more powerful than either approach alone. The statistics tell us how widespread the harm is. The interviews tell us what that harm actually feels like.

Strength3

Attention to high-risk subpopulations

35.6% of included studies focused specifically on sexual minority men — a group that is both a heavier user of dating apps and more vulnerable to mental health difficulties.

Minority Stress Theory explains why: sexual minority men already carry elevated levels of chronic psychological stress from navigating a society that marginalises them. Dating app use layers additional stressors on top of an existing burden.



Attending to who is most at risk is what distinguishes useful public health research from surface-level observation. Averaging across all populations can easily mask serious harm happening to specific communities.

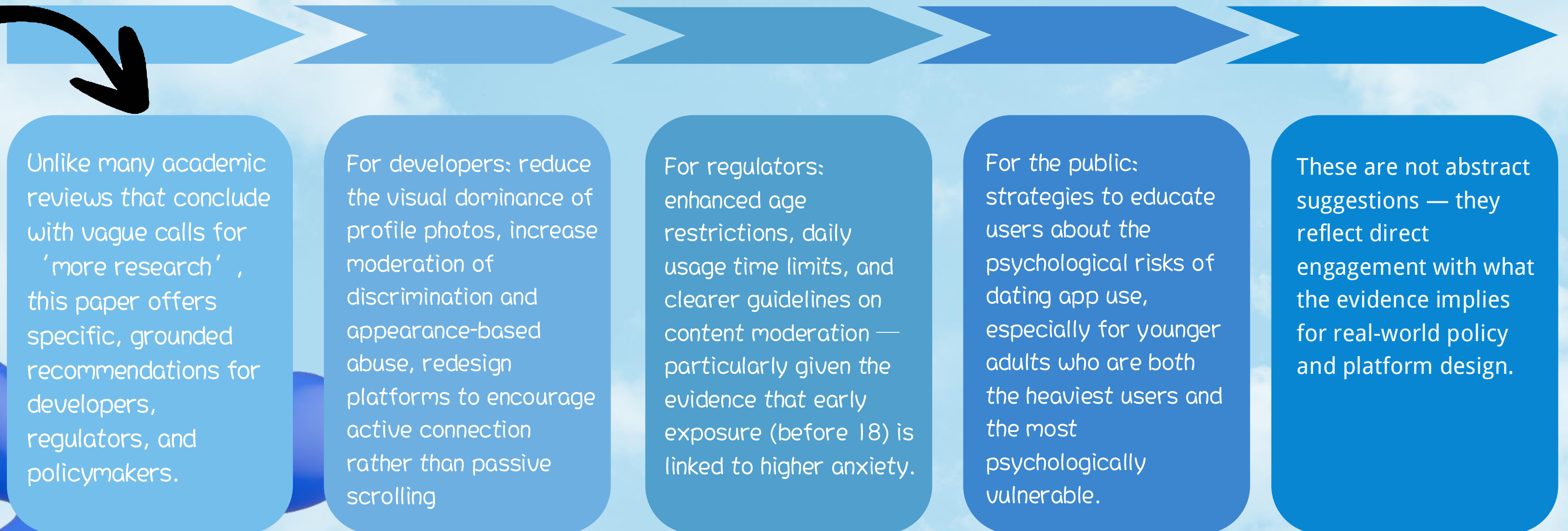


The review also examines subgroups including college students, emerging adults (18–29), and incels — demonstrating awareness that the population of dating app users is not homogeneous and that different groups may experience different outcomes.



Section4

Concrete, actionable recommendations



Section 4

Weaknesses & Critical Analysis



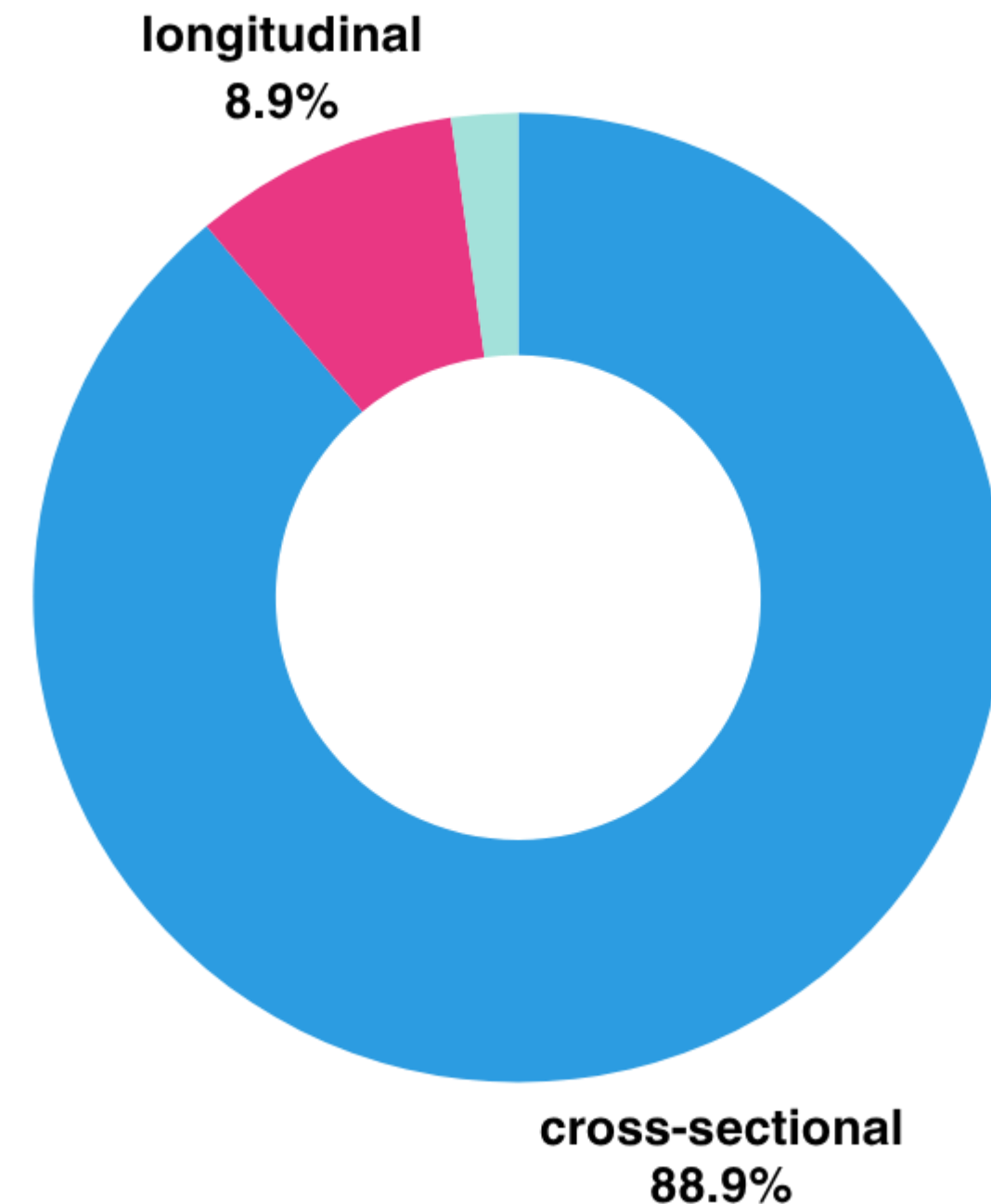
Which first ?

App Use --> Poor Mental Health:
Social comparison and rejection lead to
dissatisfaction.

OR

Pre-existing Traits ---> App Use:
Individuals with lower self-esteem may
seek external validation through apps.

Correlation $\neq$ Causation



Conclusions are drawn through prose and interpretation.

"86% of studies showed negative outcomes" is a count of findings, **not** a statistically aggregated effect size.

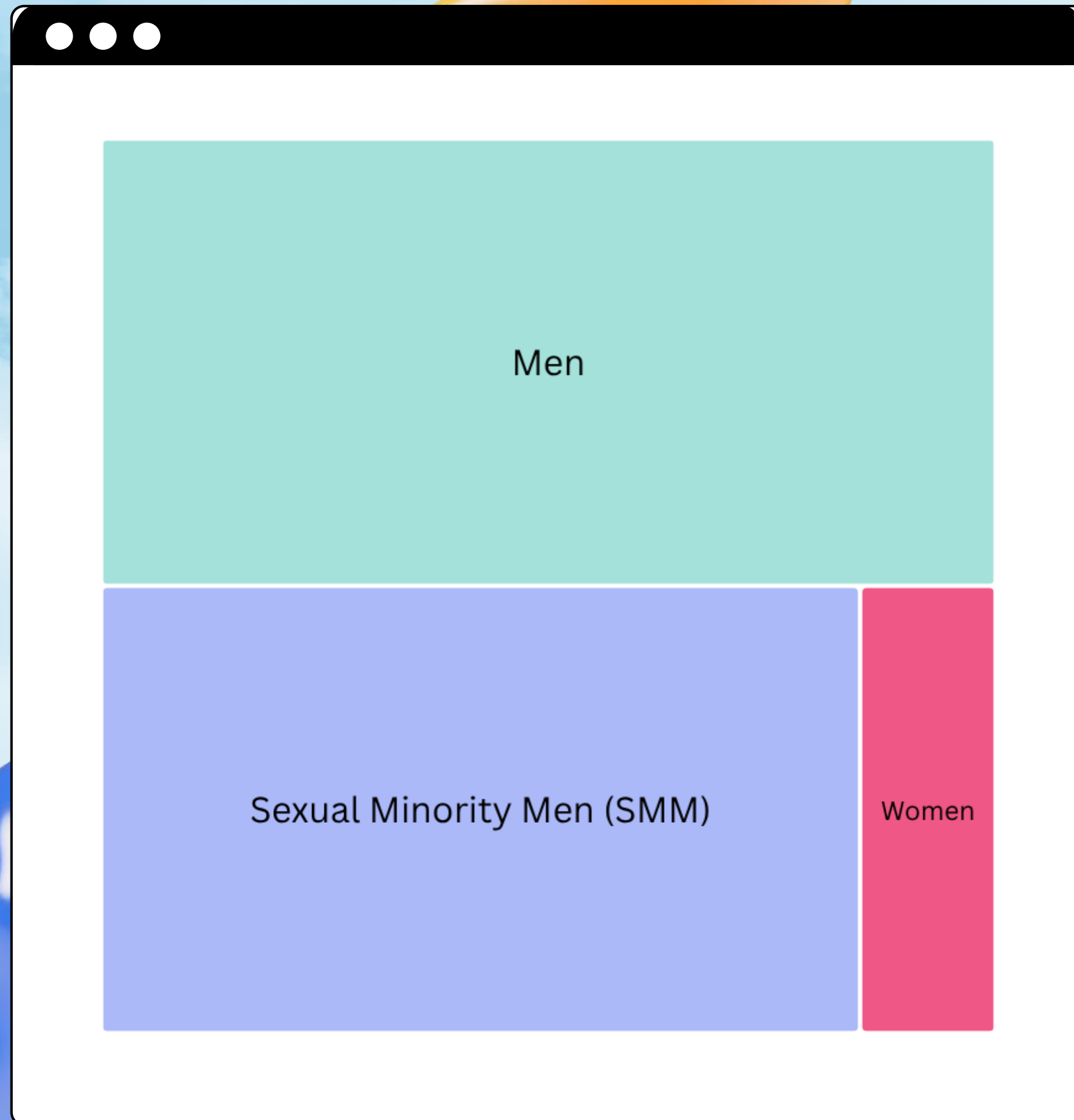
Introduces a level of subjectivity into the overall conclusions.

No Meta-Analysis was possible

Gender Representation Gap

Review conclusions are framed universally but lack sufficient data for the female experience.

Critical Analysis: Mechanisms of harm differ by gender (e.g., specific "thin-and-toned" pressures for women).



WEIRD Sampling Bias



The Statistic: 84% of studies were conducted in WEIRD contexts.



Western,
Educated
Industrialized
Rich
Democratic

Current findings may not generalize to non-Western or developing nations.

Theoretical Fragmentation

[Objectification Theory \(17.8%\)](#)

[Minority Stress Theory \(11.1%\)](#)

[18 others scattered throughout](#)



Difficult to identify which psychological mechanisms are the most critical for intervention

Section 5

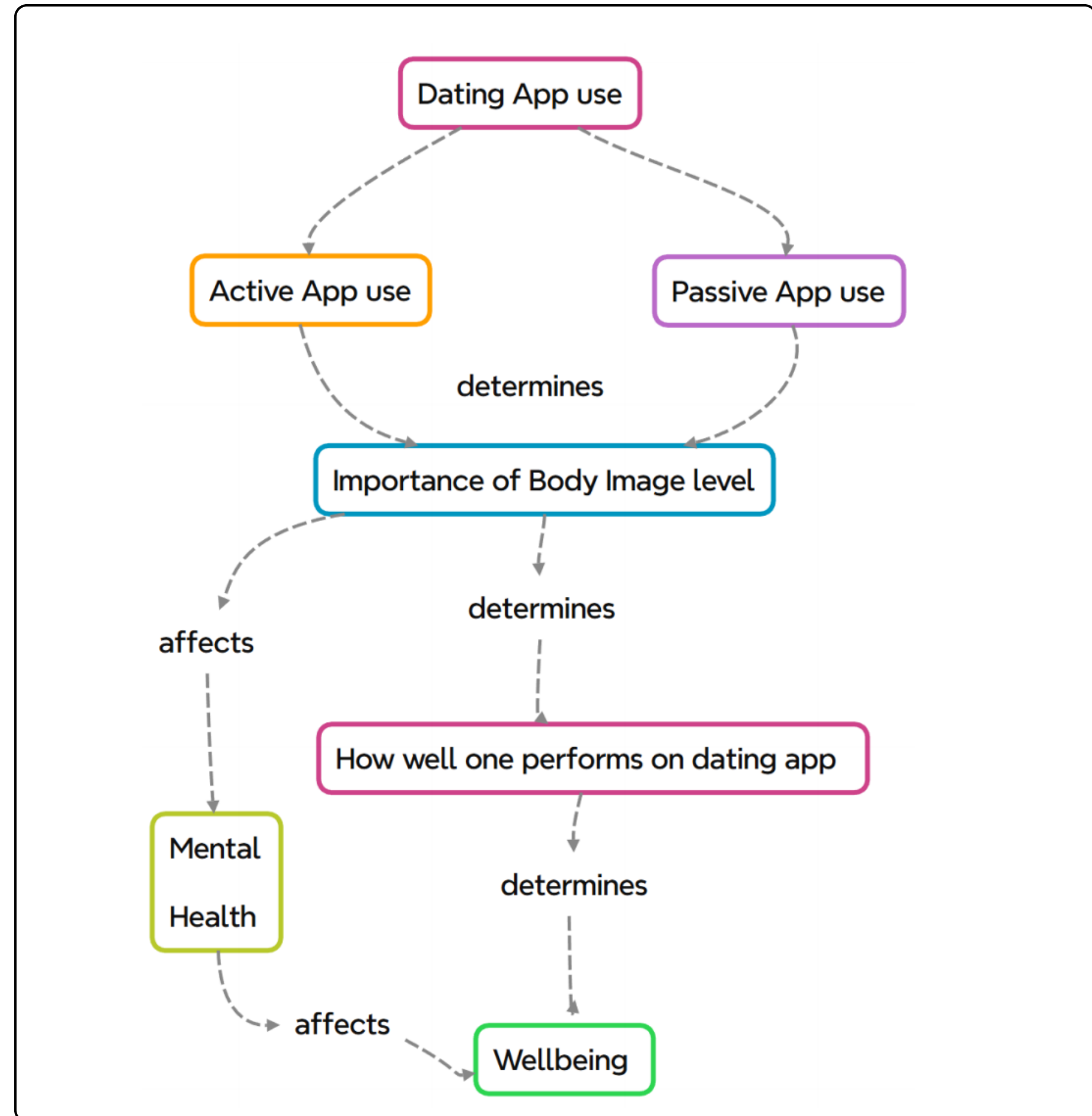
Conclusion



What does this Review tell us about the core concepts?



Conceptual Map:
Active/ Passive use of social media,
Body Image, Mental Health, Wellbeing



Future Research Directions



Effect Mechanism

The mechanism of how dating app use affects users' body image, mental health, and wellbeing



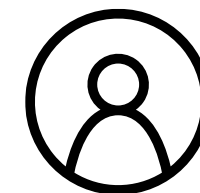
Casual Relations

Dating App use-->Mental Health and Wellbeing



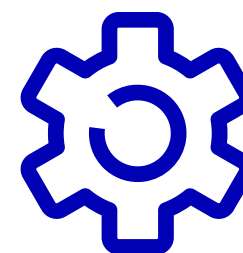
Geography

Effects of dating app use in non-Western societies



Variations

The effects of dating app use in women and non-heterosexual orientation groups



App Features

App Features that cause negative effect on mental health and

So, back to the very beginning, what about the Bumble ad?

What actually happens on dating app is considerably different from the ad visions.



Ad Visions:

Women in control

Build intentional connections

You have a choice



What actually happens:

Passive scrolling being the dominant behaviour

Judging people, and being judged

Causing harm to mental health and wellbeing

V
S

What actually happens on dating app is the matter that deserve stakeholders concern

Discussion

Would you use a dating app to expand your professional network? And if your answer is no — is that because of concerns similar to what this paper describes, or for completely different reasons?



事...

UniCareer 职优你
专注技能提升的职场大学 | 关注...
+ 关注

3 人赞同了该文章 > 听内容

现在找实习有多卷?

居然有同学在Soul上面找到了实习?!

工作了呢
在投行
你学的什么专业

那你简历给我一个

那...我考完试发给你

好的

我好久没更新简历了

真是想不到

我在soul上找了个实习

图片

现在的00后真的牛嘿~还真有人成功了!

Soul可能找不到真爱, 但能找到工作。

今日重磅福利

用tinder内推的00后们, 已经月入过万了

GQ中国
2022-02-18 13:27
+ 关注

互联网时代里, 人人都上网, 但只有 Z 世代才是真正的「网络原住民」。

作为第一批出生就接触互联网的年轻人, 他们总能开发出一些网络新用途、新玩法, 比如在抖音拉群、靠 tinder 内推、用回收站做相册.....

今天, 我们就全面追踪了一个00后 Z 世代的网络痕迹, 来学学原住民们都是怎么冲浪的。

提示: 如图文未加载, 请刷新重试

创意广告策划: GQ实验室

这是Z同学的常用APP

tinder

这是Z同学最近使用频率最高的app, 别误会, 倒不是因为他正处于感情空窗期, 而是第一批00后即将迎来大学毕业季, 在tinder上的有效求职, 已经让他收到了3份面试邀请。

Discussion



The paper concludes that dating apps are a public health concern. But dating apps are not the only platforms built around images and appearance. Do you think the same concerns apply to other social media — like Instagram, or even Xiaohongshu, which many of us use

